Muelle

A dock for Windows · version 2.0.0

Gabriel Castiglia · November 8, 2026 · version 2.0.0 · GPL-3.0-or-later license

English · Español

PDF manual: `docs/Muelle-manual-en.pdf`

Muelle is an application dock for Windows 10 and 11, written in C# with .NET 10 and WPF. It can be a floating dock with magnification under the pointer, in the style of macOS, or a fixed panel from edge to edge, in the style of Ubuntu. Its interface is available in English and Spanish; it starts in the language chosen during setup (English when it runs without installation) and can be changed at any time. "Muelle" is the Spanish word for a dock, the place where ships moor.



Requirements

- Windows 11, or Windows 10 version 1803 or later, 64-bit.

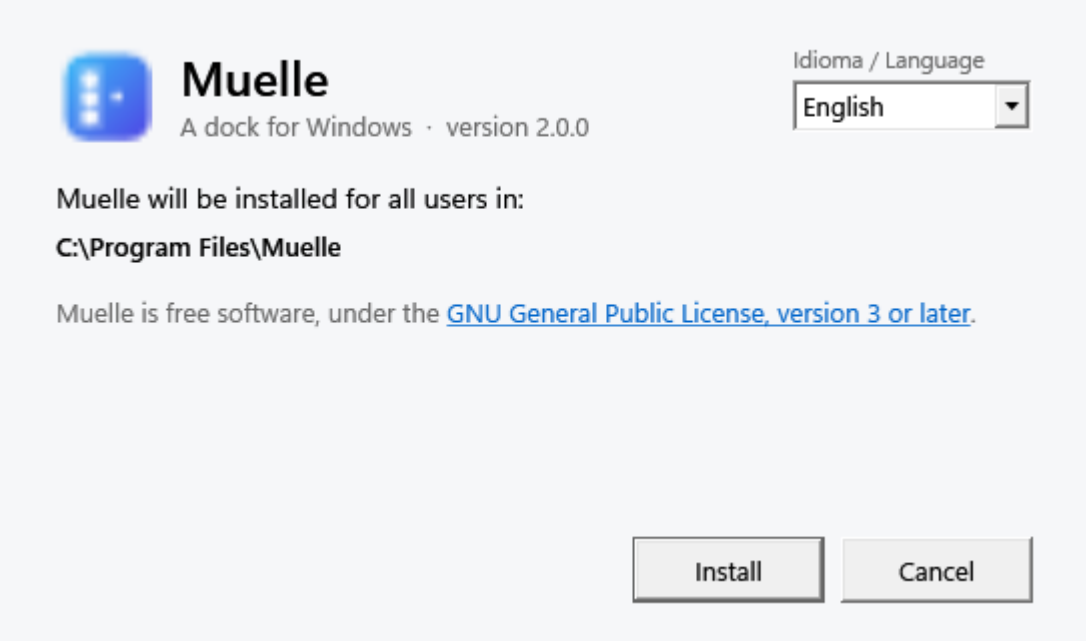
Nothing else has to be installed. Muelle carries its own .NET runtime, and the setup window runs on the .NET Framework that Windows already includes.

Installation

There are three ways to get Muelle, all built by `scripts\build.ps1` into the `dist` folder:

File	What it is
`muelle-setup.exe`	Setup program, in English or Spanish. The usual way to install.
`muelle.msi`	The same installation as a Windows Installer package, for silent installs: `msiexec /i muelle.msi /qn`.
`Muelle.exe`	The program on its own; it runs without installation from any folder.

The setup program opens a window with a language menu in its top right corner, and every page changes language at once. It installs Muelle for all users in `C:\Program Files\Muelle`, which takes administrator rights (Windows asks for them when installation starts), and adds Muelle to the Start menu. The language chosen in the setup window is the one the dock uses when it starts for the first time.



Running a newer `muelle-setup.exe` updates an installed Muelle and keeps each user's settings. If Muelle is running, setup closes it before replacing its files. An older version cannot be installed over a newer one.

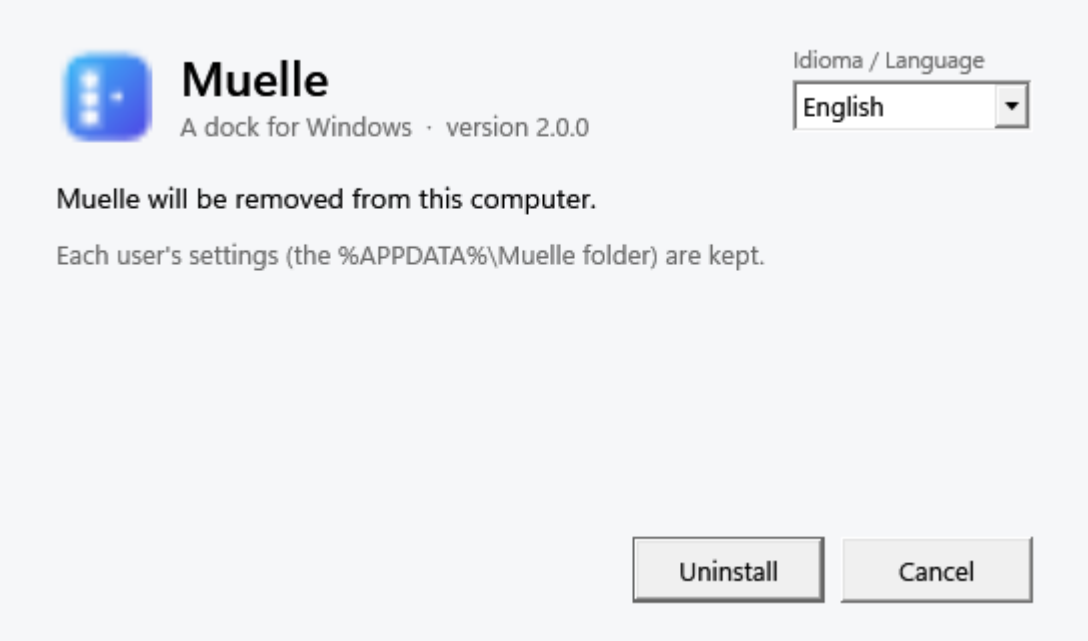
To start Muelle with Windows, turn on Settings → Behavior → "Start Muelle when Windows starts".

Uninstallation

Open Windows Settings → Apps → Installed apps, find Muelle and choose Uninstall. The same setup window opens, with its language menu, in the language chosen when Muelle was installed. It closes Muelle if it is running, removes the program and the Start menu shortcut, and deletes the "Start with Windows" entry of the user who uninstalls.

Each user's settings, in `%APPDATA%\Muelle`, are kept, so a later installation finds them. To remove them as well, delete that folder.

For an uninstall without windows: `muelle-setup.exe /uninstall /quiet`.



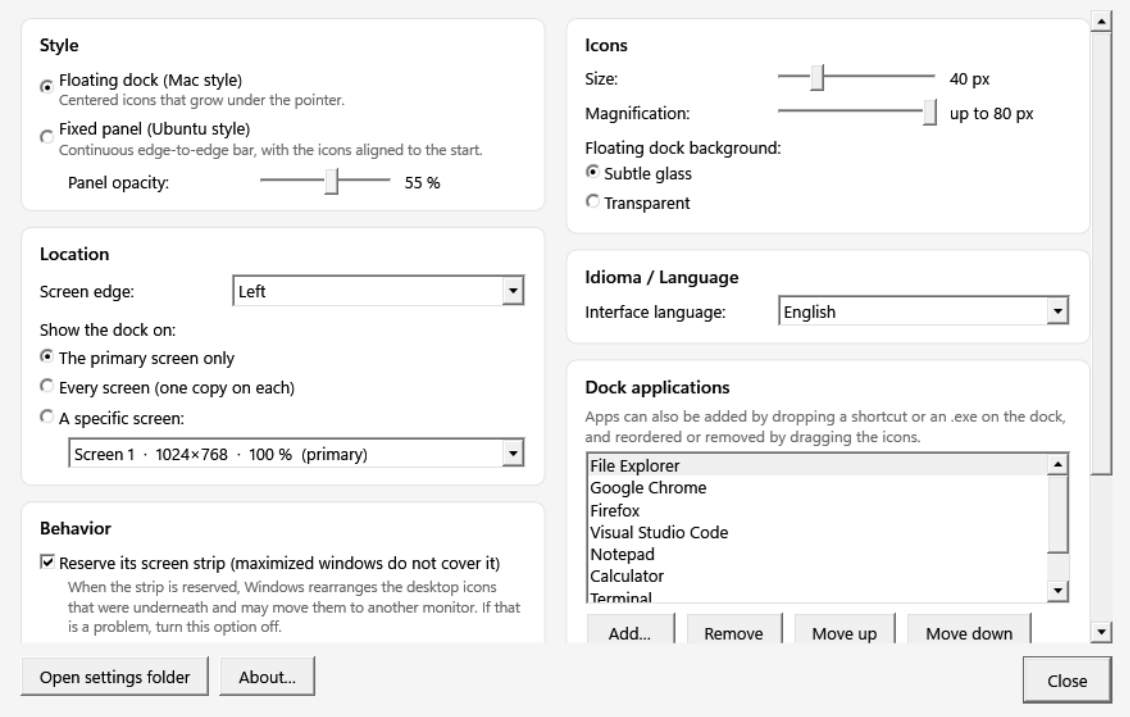
Using the dock

- A click on an icon opens the application or, if it is already open, brings its window to the front; with several windows, each click brings the next one. A click on the only window that is already in front minimizes it. Shift+click or a middle click opens a new window.
- The icon bounces while an application starts, and a dot under an icon marks an open application.
- Open applications that are not in the dock appear at its end and leave when they close. "Keep in dock" in their menu, or dragging them among the others, keeps them.
- Applications are added by dropping a shortcut or an `.exe` on the dock, with "Add application…" in the dock menu, or from Settings. Store apps (Teams, Terminal…) and shell objects such as Control Panel can be added too.
- Icons are reordered by dragging them along the dock and removed by dragging them out of it. "Lock icons" prevents both, to avoid accidental changes.
- When the icons do not fit on a screen, they shrink on that screen only.
- With a full-screen application (a video, a game) the dock moves behind it.

Right-clicking an icon offers Show (or Open), Open another window, Run as administrator, Open file location, End task (for applications with their own processes), and Keep in dock or Remove from dock. Right-clicking the dock offers Add application…, the switch between floating dock and fixed panel, Lock icons, the language menu, Settings…, About Muelle… and Quit Muelle.

Settings

Right-click the dock → Settings…. Every change applies at once.



Group	Options
Style	Floating dock (Mac style) or fixed panel (Ubuntu style); panel opacity.
Location	Screen edge; the primary screen, every screen (one copy on each) or a specific screen.
Behavior	Reserve the screen strip, hide automatically, show open apps that are not pinned, lock the icons, start with Windows.
Icons	Size (24 to 96 px), magnification under the pointer (up to twice the size), background of the floating dock.
Language	English or Spanish.
Dock applications	The list of pinned applications, with Add, Remove, Move up and Move down.

Language

The interface is in English and Spanish. The language can be changed from the dock menu (Idioma / Language, labeled in both languages so it can be found from either one) or in Settings, and it is remembered. The names of the applications that Muelle adds on its first start (File Explorer, Notepad, Calculator…) follow the interface language.

Files

What	Where
Installed program	`C:\Program Files\Muelle`
Settings	`%APPDATA%\Muelle\config.json` (it can be deleted to start over)
Error log, if anything fails	`%APPDATA%\Muelle\muelle.log`, kept under 512 KB (the previous part in `muelle.old.log`)

Known limitations

- When Muelle reserves its strip of the screen, Windows rearranges the desktop icons that were underneath and may move them to another monitor. This is how Windows treats any application bar. If it is a problem, turn off "Reserve its screen strip"; maximized windows will then go under the dock.

Building from source

With the .NET 10 SDK installed:

```
dotnet build src\Muelle\Muelle.csproj -c Release
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\build.ps1
```

The first command builds the program. The second builds everything in `dist`: the stand-alone `Muelle.exe`, `muelle.msi` and `muelle-setup.exe`; the WiX Toolset 5 is restored automatically as a NuGet package. The version is set in one place, `src\Muelle\Muelle.csproj`, and the installers and the About window read it from there.

`scripts\screenshots.ps1` renders the images in `docs\images`, and `scripts/manual.sh` (on macOS, with pandoc and Google Chrome) builds the PDF manuals from this file and `README.es.md`.

Folder	Contents
`src/Muelle`	The program.
`installer/Msi`	The MSI package (WiX).
`installer/SetupUI`	The setup window, in English and Spanish (.NET Framework 4.7.2, WPF).
`installer/Setup`	The setup program that carries the setup window and the MSI (WiX bundle).
`scripts`	Build, images, icon and manuals.
`docs`	PDF manuals, images and the manual stylesheet.

Version history

See `CHANGELOG.md`.

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